

# Stock Analysis Report

## Apple (AAPL), Microsoft (MSFT), and NVIDIA (NVDA)

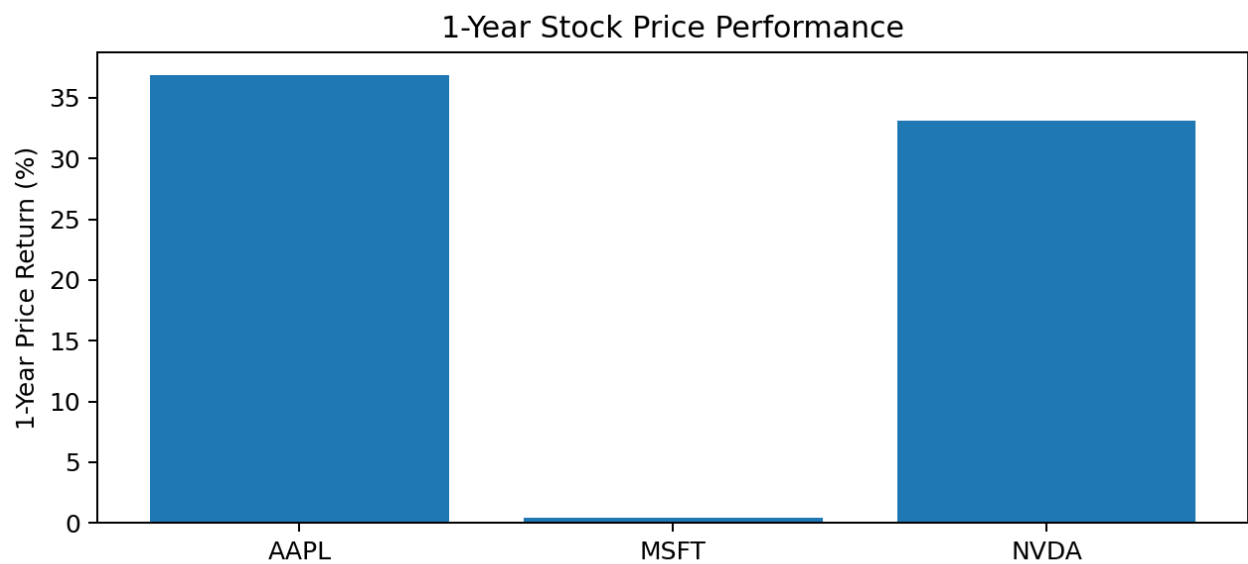
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### 1. Introduction

This report compares three major U.S. technology companies—Apple, Microsoft, and NVIDIA—using stock-price performance, valuation, market capitalization, financial performance, recent developments, and key risk factors. The analysis is educational and is not personal investment advice.

### 2. Price Trend and One-Year Performance

Using closing prices from 4 September 2025 to 3 September 2026, Apple increased from \$239.78 to \$328.21 (+36.88%), NVIDIA increased from \$171.66 to \$228.45 (+33.08%), while Microsoft moved from \$507.97 to \$510.12 (+0.42%). The comparison shows materially stronger price appreciation for Apple and NVIDIA over the selected period.



### 3. Valuation and Market Capitalization

| Metric       | Apple    | Microsoft | NVIDIA   |
|--------------|----------|-----------|----------|
| Latest close | \$328.21 | \$510.12  | \$228.45 |
| Market cap   | \$4.79T  | \$3.79T   | \$5.59T  |
| P/E (TTM)    | 37.65x   | 28.42x    | 28.88x   |
| Forward P/E  | 35.83x   | 25.82x    | 25.38x   |

Apple carries the highest trailing P/E, indicating a higher valuation relative to current earnings. Microsoft has the lowest trailing P/E among the three. NVIDIA's forward P/E is lower than its trailing P/E, reflecting expectations for continued earnings growth. Market-cap figures are approximately \$4.79T for Apple, \$3.79T for Microsoft, and \$5.59T for NVIDIA.

## 4. Performance Indicators

**Apple:** Apple closed at \$328.21 on 3 September 2026 and had a market capitalization of approximately \$4.79T. Its trailing P/E was 37.65x. The company is entering a leadership transition: John Ternus became CEO on 1 September 2026 after Tim Cook's 15-year tenure. The transition comes as Apple faces pressure to strengthen its AI strategy.

**Microsoft:** Microsoft closed at \$510.12 on 3 September 2026. Its market capitalization was approximately \$3.79T and its trailing P/E was 28.42x. Fiscal 2026 revenue reached \$331.8B, up 18%, while net income reached \$133.7B, up 31%. Azure and other cloud services revenue increased 43%, highlighting cloud and AI as major growth drivers.

**NVIDIA:** NVIDIA had a market capitalization of approximately \$5.59T and a P/E of 28.88x. In Q2 FY2027, NVIDIA reported \$96.2B of revenue, up 106% year over year, while Data Center revenue reached \$89.0B, up 117%. Gross margin was 75.0%. These figures demonstrate exceptional AI-infrastructure demand, but also increase expectations for continued growth.

## 5. Recent News and Developments

**Apple:** John Ternus officially succeeded Tim Cook as CEO on 1 September 2026. Apple's September 9 product event is expected to be an important early test of the new leadership era.

**Microsoft:** Microsoft announced a restructuring of financial reporting intended to improve transparency around AI's impact. Analysts and investors continue to focus on Azure growth and the scale of AI-related investment.

**NVIDIA:** NVIDIA's Q2 FY2027 results showed revenue of \$96.2B, up 106% year over year. The company also announced the acquisition of Hugging Face for approximately \$12.9B, strengthening its AI software ecosystem.

## 6. Risk Analysis

| Company   | Key Risks                                                                                                 |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Apple     | High valuation; AI execution; leadership transition; supply-chain and regulatory exposure.                |
| Microsoft | Large AI capital spending; valuation; cloud competition; regulatory scrutiny.                             |
| NVIDIA    | High expectations; AI-cycle dependence; supply constraints; export/geopolitical risks; higher volatility. |

## 7. Conclusion

Among the three stocks, Apple produced the strongest one-year price return in the selected period, followed closely by NVIDIA. Microsoft showed the strongest recent reported fundamental growth among the three through its FY2026 results, although its share-price return over the period was comparatively flat. NVIDIA showed the strongest current revenue growth but also carries substantial expectations and industry-specific risks. Apple combines strong market scale and price performance with a relatively high valuation and an important AI/leadership transition. Overall, the three companies offer different risk-return characteristics, making them useful subjects for comparative stock analysis.

## References

- StockAnalysis — Apple financial ratios and market capitalization.
- StockAnalysis — Microsoft financial ratios and market capitalization.
- Microsoft Investor Relations — FY2026 results.
- NVIDIA Newsroom — Q2 FY2027 results.
- Reuters/AP/The Verge — Apple CEO transition and September 2026 developments.